New Renaissance Middle School — Professional Development Plan

2026–2027 · Department, World History, and TPD tracks · New Teacher & ESE/SVE paused

BLOCK 1 · WORLD HISTORY

Welcome to MYP + Learner Profile

Development of Human Societies. Natural connection: Early humans, migration, culture, adaptation.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers introduce students to MYP and begin intentionally using Learner Profile language.

6th Grade World History: Aug 18 (Delivered)

BLOCK 1 · SESSION 1 · DEPARTMENT

Launching the IB Year

Introduce MYP expectations, department goals, planner timeline, assessment expectations, IB look-fors, and PLC norms.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete an IB Implementation Checklist and identify the first unit to develop.

Math/Sci: Aug 19 (Delivered) · ELA/SS: Aug 19 (Delivered) · Unified Arts: Aug 19 (Delivered)

BLOCK 2 · WORLD HISTORY

Learner Profile + Inquiry

Origins of Civilization / Mesopotamia. Natural connection: What makes a civilization? Why do civilizations develop?.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers reflect on Unit 1 implementation curriculum and begin brainstorming for Mesopotamia Unit. Teachers select the summative assessment that they will use for the unit.

6th Grade World History: Sep 3 (Delivered)

BLOCK 2 · SESSION 2 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Workshop 1: Start with the End in Mind

Understand the Unit Planning Process, review teacher expectations and select first summative assessment to use on the first unit planner.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers identify the first unit to plan and determine the summative assessment that will guide the first unit planner.

Math/Sci: Sep 1 (Delivered) · ELA/SS: Sep 10 (Delivered) · Unified Arts: Sep 16 (Delivered)

BLOCK 3 · WORLD HISTORY

Learner Profile + Inquiry

Origins of Civilization / Mesopotamia. Natural connection: What makes a civilization? Why do civilizations develop?.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers use LP traits while introducing factual, conceptual, and debatable questions.

6th Grade World History: Sep 22 (Delivered)

BLOCK 3 · SESSION 3 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Workshop 2: Building the Conceptual Foundation

Review components of an effective IB summative assessment, and conceptual understanding.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete the first page of the MYP Unit Planner and ensure alignment with the summative assessment.

ELA/SS: Sep 18 (Delivered) · Unified Arts: Sep 18 (Delivered) · Math/Sci: Sep 25 (Delivered)

BLOCK 4 · WORLD HISTORY

Global Contexts

Mesopotamia / Ancient Egypt & Kush. Natural connection: Geography, environment, culture, innovation, civilizations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers learn the six Global Contexts and select one that naturally frames an existing lesson.

6th Grade World History: Sep 29 (Delivered)

BLOCK 4 · SESSION 4 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Workshop 3: Designing Learning for Success

Plan the learning journey that prepares students for success on the summative assessment. Develop learning experiences, formative assessments, differentiation strategies, and intentionally embed ATL skills throughout the unit.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete the Learning Experiences, Formative Assessments, Differentiation, and ATL implementation sections of the planner.

Math/Sci: Oct 1 (Delivered) · ELA/SS: Oct 6 (Delivered) · Unified Arts: Oct 8 (Delivered)

BLOCK 5 · WORLD HISTORY

Global Contexts

Mesopotamia / Ancient Egypt & Kush. Natural connection: Geography, environment, culture, innovation, civilizations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers learn the six Global Contexts and select one that naturally frames an existing lesson.

6th Grade World History: Oct 13 (Delivered)

BLOCK 5 · SESSION 5 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Workshop 4: Reflection During Learning

Explore how teachers use ongoing reflection throughout the unit to monitor student progress and make instructional adjustments. Develop strategies for collecting evidence of learning, documenting instructional decisions, and supporting continuous improvement.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete the “During Learning” Reflection section and identify checkpoints for monitoring student understanding throughout the unit.

Math/Sci: Oct 15 (Delivered) · ELA/SS: Oct 20 (Delivered) · Unified Arts: Oct 29 (Delivered)

BLOCK 6 · WORLD HISTORY

Perspective + Open-Mindedness

Judaism & Israelite Kingdoms. Natural connection: Beliefs, cultural identity, comparing civilizations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers use historical perspective to deepen LP and conceptual thinking.

6th Grade World History: Nov 5 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 6 · SESSION 6 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Workshop 5: Reflecting Forward

Learn how meaningful end-of-unit reflection strengthens future planning. Examine student performance, assessment data, and teacher observations to determine what should be continued, revised, or removed when teaching the unit again. Introduce peer review using an MYP quality checklist.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete the Final Reflection section, participate in a planner peer review, and establish action steps for continuous improvement.

⚑ Unit Planner 1 Due

Math/Sci: Nov 10 (Scheduled) · ELA/SS: Nov 12 (Scheduled) · Unified Arts: Nov 17 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 7 · WORLD HISTORY

Perspective + Open-Mindedness

Judaism & Israelite Kingdoms. Natural connection: Beliefs, cultural identity, comparing civilizations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers use historical perspective to deepen LP and conceptual thinking.

6th Grade World History: Dec 1 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 7 · SESSION 7 · DEPARTMENT

Criterion-Based Assessment & Calibration Part 1: Understanding MYP Assessment

Understand how criterion-based assessment works, unpack the rubrics, and align assessments to the right criterion.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Analyze an MYP criterion rubric, identify evidence for each achievement level, and revise one formative assessment to align with the appropriate criteria.

Math/Sci: Dec 3 (Scheduled) · ELA/SS: Dec 8 (Scheduled) · Unified Arts: Dec 10 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 8 · WORLD HISTORY

ATL: Research Skills

Ancient India. Natural connection: Primary sources, migration, religion, social structures, achievements.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers explicitly teach one research skill using existing history content.

6th Grade World History: Dec 15 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 8 · SESSION 8 · DEPARTMENT

Criterion-Based Assessment & Calibration Part 2: Scoring Student Work

Practice scoring student work, calibrate with colleagues, and provide meaningful criterion-based feedback.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Collaboratively score student work using MYP criteria, calibrate scoring decisions, and develop criterion-based feedback for students.

⚑ Collect student examples with teacher rubrics and feedback

Math/Sci: Dec 17 (Scheduled) · ELA/SS: Jan 5 (Scheduled) · Unified Arts: Jan 7 (Scheduled)

BLOCK 9 · WORLD HISTORY

Concept-Based Learning

Ancient China / Beginning Greece. Natural connection: Power, systems, beliefs, governance, innovation, change.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers identify Key and Related Concepts already present in their curriculum.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 9 · SESSION 9 · DEPARTMENT

Semester Reflection & Unit Planner Kickoff

Reflect on first semester successes and challenges. Use those reflections to begin planning the second unit.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete first semester reflection and begin planning Unit Planner #2.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 10 · WORLD HISTORY

Concept-Based Learning

Ancient China / Beginning Greece. Natural connection: Power, systems, beliefs, governance, innovation, change.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers identify Key and Related Concepts already present in their curriculum.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 10 · SESSION 10 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Work Session

Build the second unit planner with coaching and peer support.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete the first half of Unit Planner #2.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 11 · WORLD HISTORY

ATL: Communication + Inquiry

Ancient & Classical Greece. Natural connection: Athens vs. Sparta, democracy, philosophy, debate.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers explicitly teach a communication skill through discussion, argument, or DBQ work.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 11 · SESSION 11 · DEPARTMENT

Unit Planner Work Session

Refine the planner by strengthening alignment, inquiry, and assessment.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete and revise Unit Planner #2.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 12 · WORLD HISTORY

ATL: Communication + Inquiry

Ancient & Classical Greece. Natural connection: Athens vs. Sparta, democracy, philosophy, debate.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers explicitly teach a communication skill through discussion, argument, or DBQ work.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 12 · SESSION 12 · DEPARTMENT

Student Agency & Reflection

Increase student voice, choice, ownership, and reflection throughout the inquiry process.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Redesign one learning experience to increase student agency.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 13 · WORLD HISTORY

Statement of Inquiry

Classical Rome. Natural connection: Systems, governance, power, change, citizenship.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers combine concepts + Global Context to collaboratively develop an SOI.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 13 · SESSION 13 · DEPARTMENT

Interdisciplinary Learning

Identify authentic opportunities for collaboration across subject groups and begin interdisciplinary planning.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Develop an interdisciplinary learning experience with another department.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 14 · WORLD HISTORY

Statement of Inquiry

Classical Rome. Natural connection: Systems, governance, power, change, citizenship.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers combine concepts + Global Context to collaboratively develop an SOI.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 14 · SESSION 14 · DEPARTMENT

International Mindedness

Embed authentic global perspectives and intercultural understanding throughout instruction.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Revise one lesson to intentionally strengthen international-mindedness.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 15 · WORLD HISTORY

MYP Individuals & Societies Criteria

Rome / Mesoamerica / Dynastic China. Natural connection: Comparing civilizations, sources, cause/effect, cultural diffusion.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers unpack the MYP criteria and adapt one existing assignment rather than create a new one.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 15 · SESSION 15 · DEPARTMENT

Policy Review Workshop Part 1 (Select Staff)

Review current IB policies and identify strengths, gaps, and needed revisions based on this year's implementation.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Collaboratively review assigned policy sections and recommend revisions.

Select Staff: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 16 · WORLD HISTORY

MYP Individuals & Societies Criteria

Rome / Mesoamerica / Dynastic China. Natural connection: Comparing civilizations, sources, cause/effect, cultural diffusion.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Teachers unpack the MYP criteria and adapt one existing assignment rather than create a new one.

6th Grade World History: no date (Not Started)

BLOCK 16 · SESSION 16 · DEPARTMENT

Policy Review Workshop Part 2 (Select Staff)

Finalize policy updates and ensure they reflect current school practices and IB expectations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Complete policy revisions and prepare finalized drafts for approval.

Select Staff: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · SESSION TPD · TPD

Statement of Inquiry Workshop

Review and refine Statements of Inquiry through peer feedback while exploring how the SOI should drive instruction throughout the unit. Learn strategies for referencing the SOI during lesson openings, questioning, formative assessments, discussions, and student reflection to ensure conceptual understanding remains the focus.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Peer-review and revise one Statement of Inquiry, develop lesson questions aligned to the SOI, and create a plan for intentionally using the SOI throughout the unit.

Math/Sci: no date (Not Started) · ELA/SS: no date (Not Started) · Unified Arts: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Welcome to MYP

Review expectations, answer questions, discuss the first weeks of school, and ensure teachers know where to find resources.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers leave with a support plan and key IB resources.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Unit Planner Support

Check progress on the first unit planner, troubleshoot challenges, and provide individual coaching.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers leave with next steps for completing their planner.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Teaching the Unit

Discuss how implementation is going, successes, struggles, and classroom management within inquiry-based instruction.

TAKEAWAY

Share strategies for keeping students engaged and on track.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Assessment Check-In

Answer questions about criterion-based assessment, grading, and providing feedback before first semester assessments.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers gain confidence in using MYP criteria.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Reflection & Reset

Reflect on the first semester, celebrate successes, discuss challenges, and set goals for the second semester.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers identify one instructional goal for January.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Planner #2 Coaching

Support teachers as they begin their second unit planner and answer planning questions.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers leave with a clear plan for Unit Planner #2.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Student Engagement

Share strategies for increasing inquiry, student agency, and classroom discussion.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers add one new engagement strategy to their instruction.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Preparing for the End of the Year

Discuss assessment, pacing, reflections, and preparing students for summative tasks.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers develop a plan for finishing the year strong.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · NEW TEACHER

Looking Ahead

Reflect on professional growth, discuss remaining questions, and prepare for next year.

TAKEAWAY

Teachers identify strengths and goals for the following school year.

New Teachers: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Launching the IB Year

Understanding the role of ESE in the MYP and establishing department goals.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Create an ESE action plan and identify priorities for the year.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Supporting Inclusive Unit Planning

Embedding accommodations, scaffolds, and differentiation into MYP unit planning.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Develop a planning checklist teachers can use during collaborative planning.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Universal Design for Learning (UDL)

Designing instruction that is accessible to all learners from the start.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Revise one lesson or activity using UDL principles.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Criterion-Based Assessment & Accommodations

Supporting students through criterion-based assessment while maintaining IB expectations.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Review assessment accommodations and develop support strategies.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Semester Reflection

Reflecting on student progress, instructional supports, and areas for growth.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Set department goals for the second semester.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Executive Functioning & ATL Skills

Teaching organization, self-management, and independence through ATL skills.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Create classroom tools to support executive functioning.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Co-Teaching & Collaborative Planning

Strengthening partnerships between ESE and content teachers.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Develop a co-planning protocol and communication plan.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

Student Support Case Studies

Collaboratively problem-solve real student challenges using data and instructional strategies.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Create intervention plans for selected student case studies.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)

OUT OF ROTATION · ESE/SVE

IB Inclusion Policy Review

Review and update the Inclusion Policy based on this year's implementation.

DEPARTMENT WORK / PRODUCT

Recommend revisions to the Inclusion Policy and identify next steps for the following year.

ESE/SVE: no date (Not Started)